

HP Omen Max 16

Power unleashed, literally!

With a fresh new design, HP has unveiled its latest gaming laptop yet – the Omen Max 16. Just like always, it still remains the most expensive gaming laptop, priced at ₹309,999, in HP's stable, only this time around, HP is really confident that they're absolutely nailing the value quotient. Moreover, the laptop has even taken design inspirations from some of its other laptops like the HP Omen Transcend 14 launched last year.

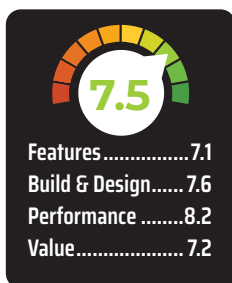
In terms of internals too, things are looking spicy. Subtle foreshadowing aside, the reason I say that is because the Omen Max 16 features a vapor chamber, replacing the good ol' traditional heat sink. Now, HP alone isn't doing this; ASUS recently also introduced its ROG Strix and ROG Strix Scar series with the vapor chamber cooling method. But regardless of who does it, the tech is useful both in terms of longevity, as it essentially lasts a lifetime.

And as the benchmarks start rolling in, you'll begin to wonder exactly how powerful the HP Omen Max 16 is. It's delivering near-desktop-level performance, comparable to yesteryear's MSI Titan laptops, which truly were desktop replacements, while this remains a mere 16-inch laptop. Albeit one that's a bit heavy, both in terms of weight and on the pocket, thanks to a retail price of ₹3,09,999. But the question remains, is the HP Omen Max 16 worth it?

DESIGN, BUILD QUALITY

From the moment I unboxed the HP Omen Max 16, I was in awe of its premium feel. The aluminium-magnesium

₹3,09,999



alloy chassis, available in Shadow Black or Ceramic White, looks and feels top-tier. It manages to walk the line perfectly between a bold gaming aesthetic and a clean, professional look. I especially liked the customizable per-key RGB lighting, tweaked easily using the OMEN Gaming Hub.

However, the chassis' finish is a fingerprint magnet and does leave noticeable smudges whenever you try to touch or grab the laptop. But one good thing is that you can easily maintain a good grip on the laptop because of its texture. Also, HP isn't offering the Ceramic White variant in India, which is a shame, because it would've been a looker, a big, bold, white laptop, which is rarely seen out in the wild. It also would've attracted far fewer fingerprints.

In terms of weight, at just under 6 pounds (2.68 kg), it's not the lightest laptop around, but I found it surprisingly portable for a 16-inch gaming machine. The build is solid, I can open

the lid with one hand, which is always a nice touch. That said, I do notice a bit of give in the lid and hinges, which makes me wonder about long-term durability.

The keyboard is definitely one of the highlights. The frameless layout and light bar give it that high-end gaming vibe. While I appreciated the aesthetic and enjoyed using it for both gaming

and work, I did find the keys a bit mushy at times, and there's some slight flex if you press down hard. Not a deal-breaker, but something to be aware of if you're into long gaming sessions or heavy typing.

One of my favourite things about the Omen Max 16 is the thoughtful port placement. Also, the single USB-A port sits at the far end near the hinge on the right side, which keeps the entire right side clutter-free. This layout keeps my desk clean and my setup streamlined, whether I'm gaming or multitasking for work. The touchpad, on the other hand, feels a little less premium for this price. It's absolutely fine in terms of size, but I really wish HP offered a haptic touchpad instead of a mechanical one.

PERFORMANCE

So, globally, HP offers three types of displays: one with an FHD+ IPS panel, a QHD+ IPS panel, and one with an OLED panel. In India, HP is only offering the mid-range display on the HP Omen Max 16, which comes equipped with a 16-inch IPS panel boasting a 2560 × 1600 resolution and a 16:10 aspect ratio. In my testing I found that display has 586 nits of peak brightness. Combine that with its matte coating and you get a display which is easily usable in an outside environment like a coffee shop.

In terms of sRGB coverage as well, the Omen Max 16's display achieves 100% coverage, making it great for designers, especially those who create content for the web and online media. However, the pristine IPS panel does take a hit in terms of DCI-P3 colour space coverage which is only around 80% DCI-P3. The display also offers a variable refresh rate from 60Hz to